

QOARC

DESIGN SYSTEM — VERSION 0.6

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# Portfolio Design System

The visual language every case study in this portfolio is built from — color, type, space, elevation, and the components assembled out of them.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

# One system, every project.

This is a reference, not a finished layout. Each project page in the portfolio inherits everything defined here, so the work stays the subject and the frame around it stays quiet and consistent.

Every value lives in `CSS/TOKENS.CSS` as a custom property. When a new pattern appears, it either maps onto something already documented or earns a new token — nothing gets a one-off value.

01

## Weight is the hierarchy

One family carries the interface. Emphasis comes from weight and scale, never from adding another typeface.

02

## One accent per view

Signal Teal marks exactly one thing on any given page. If two elements compete for it, neither is an accent.

03

## Depth reads as light

Surfaces lighten as they rise and catch a highlight on the top edge. Shadow alone is not elevation.

04

## The work is the color

The palette stays near-neutral so project screenshots supply the color on any page they appear.

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02 — COLOR

# Palette

Five brand colors carry the entire system. Four of them are structural — surfaces, text, and rules. Only Signal Teal is an accent.

**Deep Space**  
#0A1830  
Primary background

**Oxford Navy**  
#0F2244  
Headings, filled shapes

**Slate**  
#6B7A94  
Captions, rules, line art

**Paper White**  
#F7F7F9  
Light surfaces, text on dark

**Signal Teal**  
#2DD4BF  
Accent — one per view

DERIVED STATES

|               |         |
|---------------|---------|
| TEAL HOVER    | #5EE6D5 |
| TEAL ACTIVE   | #22A895 |
| TEAL ON PAPER | #0E9E8B |

ELEVATION LADDER

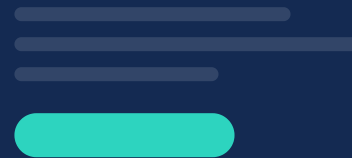
|                 |         |
|-----------------|---------|
| ELEV 0 — PAGE   | #0A1830 |
| ELEV 1 — PANEL  | #101F3C |
| ELEV 2 — CARD   | #142A52 |
| ELEV 3 — RAISED | #1B3564 |

## 02 — COLOR

# One accent per view.

Signal Teal is the only color in the system permitted to draw attention, and it may appear once on any given screen — a single button, a single active nav state, or a single highlighted figure.

The rule holds because the palette around it is deliberately quiet. Two teal elements on one page cancel each other out, and the eye loses the thing that mattered.

**CORRECT**

One teal element. The eye lands where it should.

**INCORRECT**

Three teal elements. Nothing reads as primary.

03 — TYPOGRAPHY

# Three families, three jobs.

HANKEN GROTESK — BRAND, ALL UI

400 / 500 / 600 / 700 / 800

**Regular** — Designing systems that scale with the work.

**Semibold** — Designing systems that scale with the work.

**Extrabold** — Designing systems that scale with the work.

JETBRAINS MONO — TECHNICAL, THE SIGNATURE

UPPERCASE • TRACKED 0.08EM

PROJECT\_04 / CASE STUDY / 2026

FRAUNCES — EDITORIAL, READING ONLY

NEVER UI • NEVER GRAPHICS

Used only where someone is actually reading — a case study narrative or a blog post — never on a button, a nav label, or a chart.

## 03 — TYPOGRAPHY

# Fluid scale

A minor-third ratio, clamped between a floor and ceiling so headings shrink on small screens without a second stylesheet.

|                  |            |
|------------------|------------|
| 5XL — DISPLAY    | 56 → 96 px |
| 4XL — PAGE TITLE | 44 → 72 px |
| 3XL — SECTION    | 36 → 52 px |
| 2XL — SUBSECTION | 30 → 40 px |
| XL — CARD TITLE  | 24 → 30 px |
| BASE — BODY      | 16 px      |
| SM — CAPTION     | 14 px      |
| XS — LABEL       | 12 px      |

5XL

**Aa**

3XL

**Aa Bb Cc**

XL

**Aa Bb Cc Dd**

BASE

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

SM

Caption and metadata size — pairs with Slate.

## 04 — SPACE &amp; GRID

# 4px base, t-shirt named.

Every margin, padding, and gap pulls from this scale. A spacing need that doesn't fit is a signal to reconsider the layout, not to reach for an arbitrary value.

|          |             |
|----------|-------------|
| 3XS · 4  | <div></div> |
| 2XS · 8  | <div></div> |
| XS · 12  | <div></div> |
| SM · 16  | <div></div> |
| MD · 24  | <div></div> |
| LG · 32  | <div></div> |
| XL · 48  | <div></div> |
| 2XL · 64 | <div></div> |
| 3XL · 96 | <div></div> |

TWELVE COLUMNS · MAX 1440PX · FLUID GUTTER



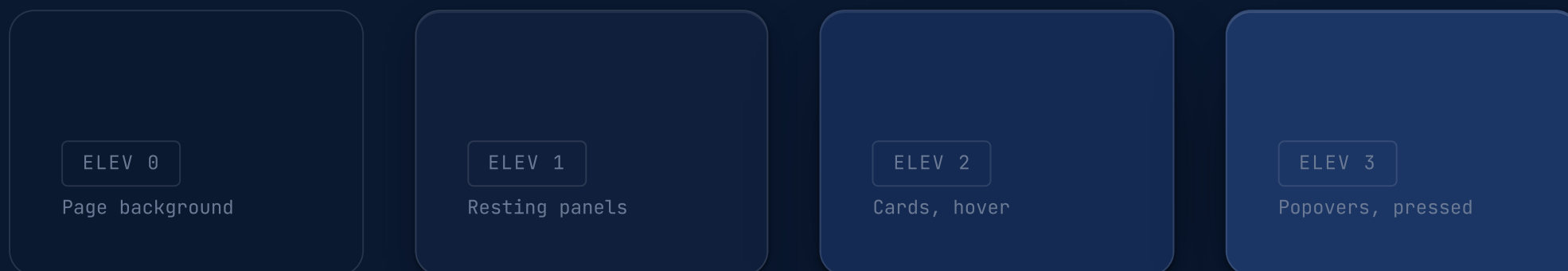
|                |             |
|----------------|-------------|
| CONTAINER MAX  | 1440 px     |
| GUTTER         | 24 px       |
| SECTION RHYTHM | 64 → 144 px |



## 05 — ELEVATION

# Four rungs, light from above.

Depth comes from three things at once: the surface lightens as it rises, a hairline highlight catches its top edge, and a two-layer shadow — tight contact plus wide ambient — grounds it.



CONTACT SHADOW

0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,.4)

AMBIENT SHADOW

0 8px 24px -8px rgba(0,0,0,.5)

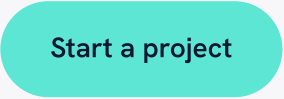
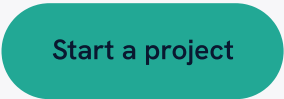
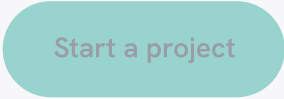
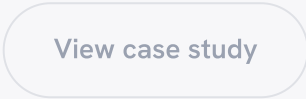
HIGHLIGHT EDGE

inset 0 1px 0 rgba(247,247,249,.09)

## 06 — BUTTONS

# Primary, secondary, ghost.

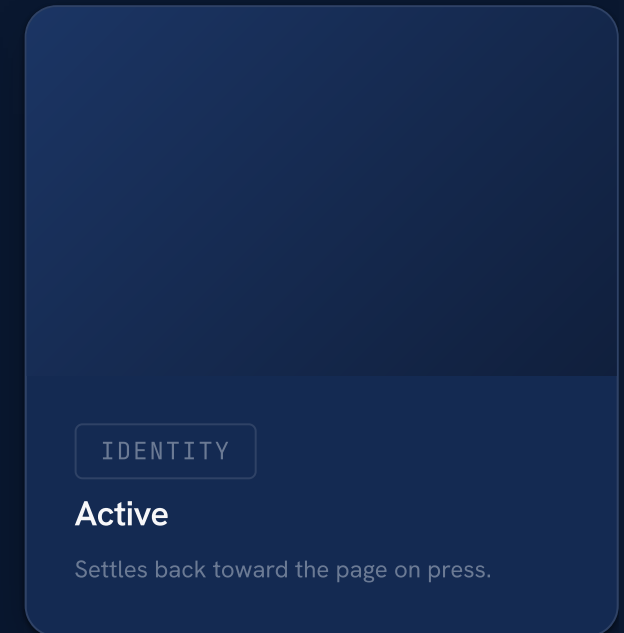
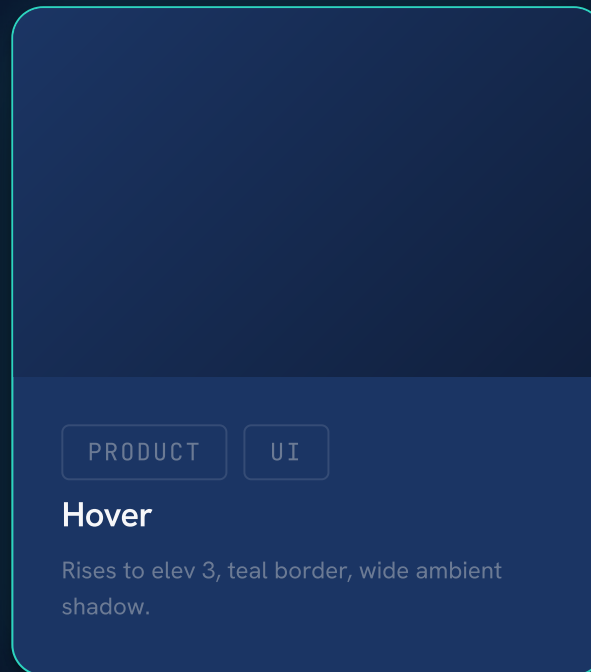
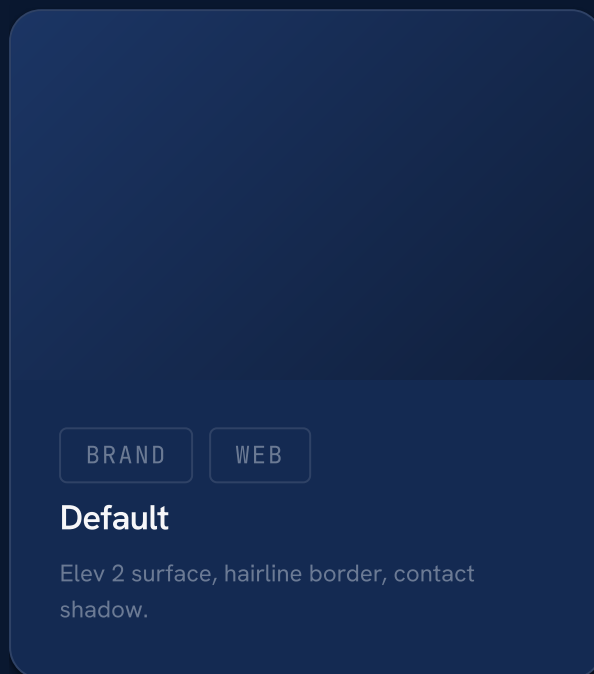
Only one primary button appears in a view. Secondary carries every other real action; ghost is for tertiary controls in dense interfaces.

|           | DEFAULT                                                                           | HOVER                                                                              | ACTIVE                                                                              | DISABLED                                                                            |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PRIMARY   |  |  |  |  |
| SECONDARY |  |  |  |  |
| GHOST     | Skip                                                                              | Skip                                                                               | Skip                                                                                | Skip                                                                                |
| PADDING   | 12px / 24px                                                                       |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| RADIUS    | Full pill                                                                         |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| LABEL     | Hanken Grotesk 600 · 14px                                                         |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| BUTTONS   | 10                                                                                |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |

## 07 — PROJECT CARD

# The unit the grid is built from.

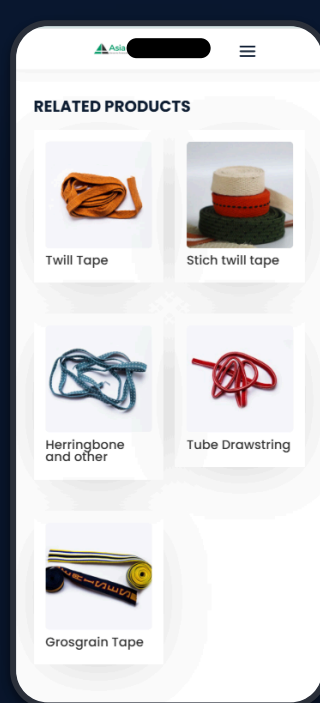
On hover the surface climbs a rung, the border picks up the accent, and the ambient shadow widens. Screenshots supply all the color.



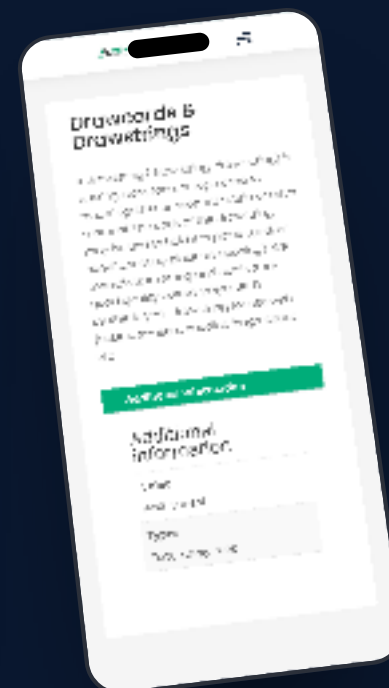
## 08 — DEVICE MOCKUPS

# Phone — four views.

Carrying Asia Linkage, a garments accessories catalogue. Each screen slot is cut to the true device ratio, so a shot exported at 393 × 852 lands without distortion.



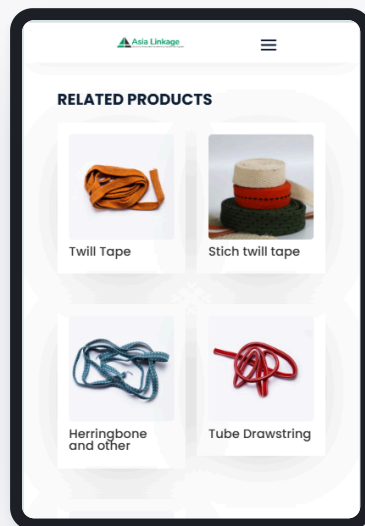
FRONT — RELATED PRODUCTS

THREE-QUARTER LEFT —  
PRODUCTTHREE-QUARTER RIGHT —  
GALLERY

TILTED — DETAILS

## 08 — DEVICE MOCKUPS

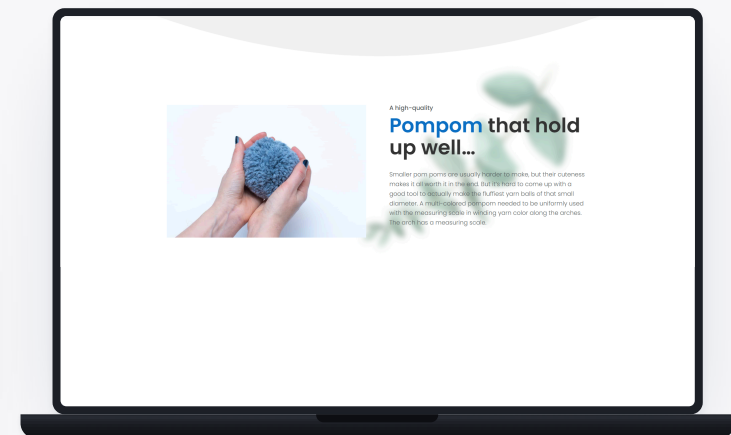
# Tablet & laptop.



TABLET — PORTRAIT



TABLET — LANDSCAPE, ANGLED

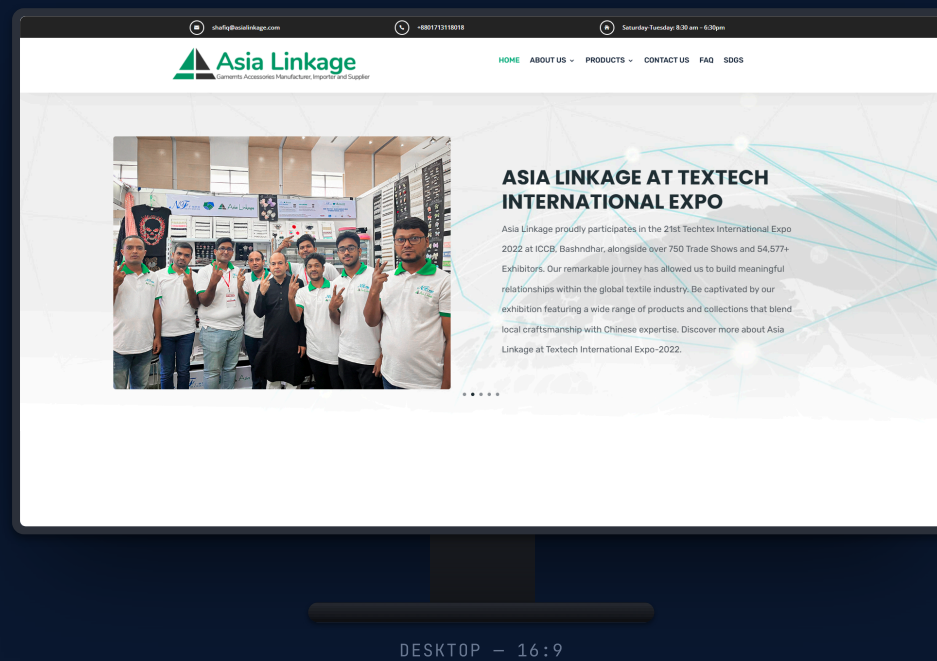


LAPTOP — FRONT

## 08 — DEVICE MOCKUPS

# Desktop & scene.

The composition row sits devices on a shared baseline so a responsive set reads as one scene rather than three separate specimens.



## 08 — DEVICE MOCKUPS

# Dropping artwork in.

An `IMG` in the screen slot covers the placeholder automatically — frame, angle and bezel never change.

## EXPORT AT THESE SIZES

|                  |                    |
|------------------|--------------------|
| PHONE            | 393 × 852 (19.5:9) |
| TABLET PORTRAIT  | 820 × 1180         |
| TABLET LANDSCAPE | 1180 × 820         |
| LAPTOP           | 1440 × 900 (16:10) |
| DESKTOP          | 1920 × 1080 (16:9) |

## AVAILABLE ANGLES

|                         |                               |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|
| QO-VIEW--FRONT          | Flat, straight on             |
| QO-VIEW--LEFT / --RIGHT | Three-quarter, $\pm 30^\circ$ |
| QO-VIEW--TILT           | Tilted and rotated            |
| QO-VIEW--RECLINE        | Laid back $26^\circ$          |
| QO-VIEW--ISO            | Isometric                     |

## MARKUP

```
<div class="qo-device qo-device--phone qo-view--left">
  <div class="qo-device__frame">
    <div class="qo-screen" data-spec="393 × 852">
      
    </div>
  </div>
</div>
```



RECLINE

ISOMETRIC

TABLET TILT

# Every value lives in tokens.css

Change a token and the whole document — and every page built on it — follows. New patterns either map onto what is documented here or earn a new token.